

Over the past few years, the conversation around Artificial Intelligence has swung between extremes—will it save us or replace us? But as I look back on my discussions with industry leaders, creators and developers in 2025, it's clear that something more profound has happened. AI didn't make a dramatic entrance as many had anticipated; instead, it quietly wove itself into the fabric of our daily lives, often unnoticed.

The spectacle of viral demos and headline-grabbing models of 2023 and 2024 has given way to a new reality: in 2025, we no longer asked, "What can AI do?" but rather, "Where does AI fit?" In 2025, AI stopped trying to impress us and started trying to work for us.

From reshaping how we market, create and drive social change, its impact is immediate and tangible. And nowhere is this transformation more evident than in India, where we are uniquely positioned to lead the global AI revolution. With a vast, youthful and tech-savvy population, India stands out for its deep mobile-first culture and a thriving startup ecosystem. The country's robust digital public infrastructure—built on the strong foundation of mobile access, Aadhaar and UPI, the largest digital payment ecosystem in the world—further provides a powerful foundation for innovation at scale.

Illustration by **NILANJAN DAS / AI**